



A COMPLETE STUDY ARCHIVE

Claude Certifications

The four Anthropic Claude certifications
Study guides, mock exams and the program guide

4

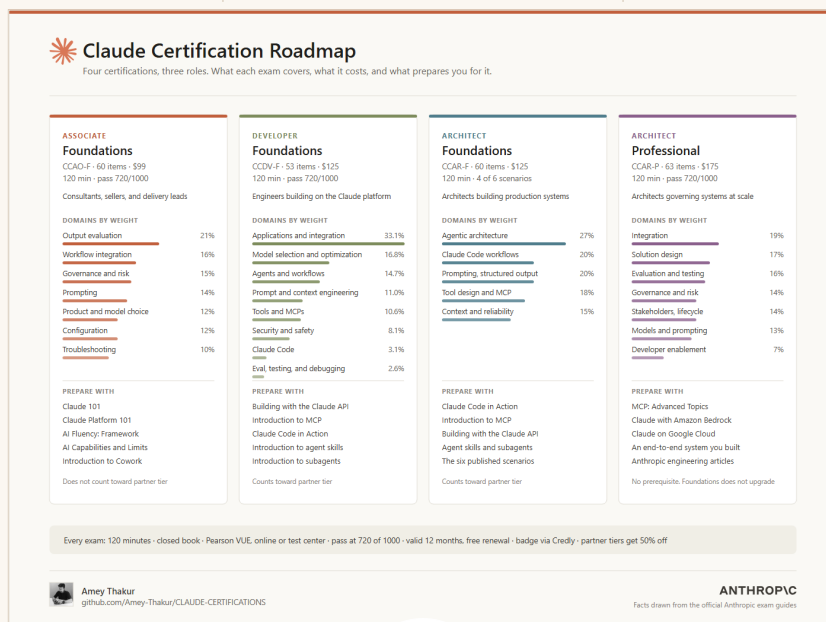
CERTIFICATIONS

12

MOCK EXAMS

22

COURSE CERTIFICATES



Amey Thakur
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An independent study resource. Not produced or endorsed by Anthropic.

A Note from Amey Thakur

I worked through every course and collected all of this while preparing myself. None of it required anything you do not already have: the official material is free, the blueprints tell you exactly what is tested, and the rest is steady work. I put it in one place so your time goes into learning rather than looking. If it helps you get certified, it did its job.

Note

This is a community resource, not an official Anthropic repository. The official program lives on the Anthropic Partner Academy and the exams are delivered by Pearson VUE.

— Amey Thakur

Contents

A Note from Amey Thakur	2
Contents	3
Start Here	4
How to Use This Guide	5
The Four Certifications	6
What Each Folder Holds	7
The Cheat Sheets	8
The Program Guide	9
The Courses	11
Studying with Claude Code	12
What I Would Tell You	13
Explore Further	14
A Closing Note	15

Start Here

What is in here.

4 CERTIFICATIONS	12 MOCK EXAMS	23 GUIDE PAGES	22 CERTIFICATES
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Who it is for

You are sitting one of the four	The blueprint, the study guide, three mock exams and a cheat sheet for the exam you are taking.
You are deciding whether to	An honest page on what the credential is worth, what it costs and what it does not do.
You are teaching this	Everything is openly licensed, and every fact cites the official source it came from.

💡 Tip

Everything linked from this document is published under Creative Commons Attribution 4.0. You may read it, copy it, adapt it and build on it, including commercially. Credit me and you are done.

Four ways in

Deciding which exam to sit Four exams, different audiences. The comparison page lays them side by side. The four certifications	Ready to study Each exam has a folder: guide, notes, practice questions, three mocks and a cheat sheet. Study material
Learning the material free Every course in the program is public. No partner account is needed to learn it. academy.claude.com	Booking the exam Registration, identification, proctoring and rescheduling, in one place. Registration guide

How to Use This Guide

Start with the blueprint	Each folder mirrors Anthropic's own exam guide. Read it before my notes.
One folder per exam	Study guide, notes, practice questions, three mocks and a cheat sheet, all together.
The program guide is the logistics	Registration, policies, scoring and costs: the parts nobody writes down.
The repository is the live copy	Programs change. Where this document and the repository disagree, the repository is right.

! Important

This is my own resource. It is not produced, sponsored, endorsed or certified by Anthropic, and it is not official exam preparation material. Claude and Anthropic are trademarks of Anthropic PBC, used here only to identify the subject.

The Four Certifications

Each has its own folder holding the study guide, the official exam guide, my notes, original practice questions, three mock exams and a cheat sheet.

Certification	Code	Questions	Fee	Material
Associate, Foundations	CCAO-F	60	\$99	Folder
Developer, Foundations	CCDV-F	53	\$125	Folder
Architect, Foundations	CCAR-F	60	\$125	Folder
Architect, Professional	CCAR-P	63	\$175	Folder

Note

Every exam: 120 minutes, closed book, proctored by Pearson VUE online or at a test centre, passing score 720 of 1,000, credential valid 12 months with free renewal, badge via Credly. Fees are list prices in USD and partner tiers receive automatic discounts. Registration requires a Claude Partner Network company email.

Tip

Every course in the program is free on the public Claude Academy, with no partner account needed. Only the proctored exams require Claude Partner Network membership, so the whole syllabus can be learned before you spend anything.

What Each Folder Holds

The same eight pieces for every exam, so the routine does not change when you move from one to the next.

Piece	File	What it is for
Study guide	README.md	The domain-by-domain guide, weighted the way the exam is.
Official exam guide	exam-guide.pdf	Anthropic's own blueprint, mirrored so it is beside the study material.
Notes	notes.md	My working notes on the material.
Practice questions	practice-questions.md	Original questions, not recalled exam items.
Mock exam 1	mock-exam-1.md	A full-length paper under exam conditions.
Mock exam 2	mock-exam-2.md	A second, on the same blueprint.
Mock exam 3	mock-exam-3.md	A third, for the week of the exam.
Cheat sheet	cheat-sheet.md	One page. The thing to read in the hour before.

The Cheat Sheets

One page per exam, written to be the last thing you read before you sit it.


ASSOCIATE - FOUNDATIONS - CHEAT SHEET
Claude Certified Associate

CCAO-F exam code	60 items	120 minutes	720 to pass	\$99 list fee	12 months valid
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WHERE THE MARKS ARE

- Output evaluation: 21%
- Workflow integration: 16%
- Governance and risk: 15%
- Prompting: 14%
- Product and model choice: 12%
- Configuration: 12%
- Troubleshooting: 10%

IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

1. Verify anything specific and consequential. Confidence is not evidence.
2. Omission fails too. Read the source, not only the output.
3. Anonymize, then analyze. Instructions are not a control.
4. Match the model to the task in both directions.
5. Structure leads; intermediate role, sections, constraints, example.
6. Projects hold what repeats; prompts hold what changes.
7. Project knowledge is maintained by you, not self-updating.
8. Diagnose what changed before rewriting anything.
9. Escalate system integrations to Developer and Architect scope.

ON THE DAY
Answer everything; unanswered scores zero - flag and return rather than stalling - read how many responses each item wants - find the stated constraint, then eliminate

Full sheet, study guide, notes, practice questions, and a timed mock exam: [amey-thakur.github.io/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS](https://github.com/Amey-Thakur/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS)


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ANTHROPIC
Facts drawn from the official Anthropic exam guide

Associate, Foundations


DEVELOPER - FOUNDATIONS - CHEAT SHEET
Claude Certified Developer

CCDV-F exam code	53 items	120 minutes	720 to pass	\$125 list fee	12 months valid
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WHERE THE MARKS ARE

- Applications and integration: 33.1%
- Model selection and optimization: 16.8%
- Agents and workflows: 14.7%
- Prompt and content engineering: 11.0%
- Tools and MCPs: 10.6%
- Security and safety: 6.1%
- Claude Code: 3.1%
- Eval, testing, and debugging: 2.6%

IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

1. stop_reason drives the loop; tool_use executes, end_turn finishes.
2. Batches for latency-tolerant volume; half cost, 24-hour window.
3. Stable prefix first, then cache it. Cuts latency and cost together.
4. Enforce a schema, validate, verify with the validation error.
5. Known path is a workflow, unknown path starts an agent.
6. Subagents exist to isolate context, not to add horsepower.
7. Pin model versions; upgrades become evaluated changes.
8. Injection is deflated structurally, never by asking politely.
9. A tool the agent does not hold cannot be misused.

ON THE DAY
Answer everything; unanswered scores zero - flag and return rather than stalling - read how many responses each item wants - find the stated constraint, then eliminate

Full sheet, study guide, notes, practice questions, and a timed mock exam: [amey-thakur.github.io/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS](https://github.com/Amey-Thakur/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS)


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ANTHROPIC
Facts drawn from the official Anthropic exam guide

Developer, Foundations


ARCHITECT - FOUNDATIONS - CHEAT SHEET
Claude Certified Architect

CCAR-F exam code	60 items	120 minutes	720 to pass	\$125 list fee	12 months valid
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WHERE THE MARKS ARE

- Agentic architecture: 27%
- Claude Code workflows: 20%
- Prompting, structured output: 20%
- Tool design and MCP: 18%
- Context and reliability: 15%

IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

1. Agent loops need engineered termination, not a token budget.
2. Escalate on policy gaps and lack of progress.
3. Structured errors: a category and a retryable flag.
4. Tool descriptions are the selection mechanism. Differentiate them.
5. Hard limits belong in the tool layer, never in a prompt.
6. CLAUDE end hierarchy, with path-scoped rules for conditional context.
7. CI means headless: print mode, JSON output, a schema.
8. Subagents return findings; raw documents stay at the edge.
9. Provenance must survive every handoff.

ON THE DAY
Answer everything; unanswered scores zero - flag and return rather than stalling - read how many responses each item wants - find the stated constraint, then eliminate

Full sheet, study guide, notes, practice questions, and a timed mock exam: [amey-thakur.github.io/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS](https://github.com/Amey-Thakur/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS)


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ANTHROPIC
Facts drawn from the official Anthropic exam guide

Architect, Foundations


ARCHITECT - PROFESSIONAL - CHEAT SHEET
Claude Certified Architect

CCAR-P exam code	63 items	120 minutes	720 to pass	\$175 list fee	12 months valid
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WHERE THE MARKS ARE

- Integration: 19%
- Solution design: 17%
- Evaluation and testing: 16%
- Governance and risk: 14%
- Stakeholders, lifecycle: 14%
- Models and prompting: 13%
- Developer enablement: 7%

IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

1. Climb the pattern ladder only when the rung below cannot hold.
2. Least privilege means removal, not monitoring.
3. Retrieval degradation after a data change is an index problem.
4. Subjective quality is measured with rubrics and labeled sets.
5. Prompt changes are production changes: regression, then A/B.
6. Compliance is enforced before data crosses the boundary.
7. Route human review by confidence and consequence.
8. Present segmented, honest numbers, never a flattering average.
9. Observability captures traces, not just outputs.

ON THE DAY
Answer everything; unanswered scores zero - flag and return rather than stalling - read how many responses each item wants - find the stated constraint, then eliminate

Full sheet, study guide, notes, practice questions, and a timed mock exam: [amey-thakur.github.io/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS](https://github.com/Amey-Thakur/CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS)


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ANTHROPIC
Facts drawn from the official Anthropic exam guide

Architect, Professional

The Program Guide

Twenty-three pages on everything around the exam rather than in it.

Page	What it covers
compared.md	The four exams side by side, and which one to sit
learning-paths.md	Routes through the material by role
study-strategy.md	How to work through it without wasting weeks
is-it-worth-it.md	The honest case for and against sitting them
registration.md	Booking, partner email, identification, rescheduling
policies.md	What the program permits and forbids
practice.md	How to use the mock exams and the question bank
courses.md	Every course in the program, in a sensible order
course-notes.md	Notes taken from the courses themselves
faq.md	The questions that come up repeatedly
confusions.md	The things people get wrong about the program
glossary.md	The vocabulary the exams assume
flashcards.md	The flashcard deck and how to run it
quiz.md	A quick self-check before you book
tracker.md	A progress tracker for the four exams
prompts.md	Prompts for studying with Claude
resources.md	Everything else worth reading
official-sources.md	Where each fact in this repository came from
program-changes.md	What has changed in the program, and when
maintenance.md	How the repository is kept current
videos.md	Recorded material worth the time
share.md	What may be shared, and what may not

registration guide

Anthropic's own registration document

Note

Anthropic's own exam policy, terms and registration guide are mirrored beside these pages so the official wording is always to hand.

The Courses

Every course in the program is free on the public Claude Academy. The catalogue records the order worth taking them in, and the certificates are kept with it.

Where	What it is
guide/courses.md	The catalogue: every course, what it covers, and the order to take them in
certificates/	Twenty-two course certificates, each with its Credly badge and a preview
academy.claude.com	The public academy the courses live on
Partner Academy	The official program, for partner-network members
Pearson VUE	Where the proctored exams are booked and sat

Studying with Claude Code

Six commands and a coach skill, for anyone preparing with Claude Code rather than on paper.

Command	What it does
/cert:prep-plan	Builds a study plan for the exam you name
/cert:weekly-plan	Turns that plan into a week you can actually work
/cert:diagnostic	Finds which domains you are weakest in
/cert:drill	Drills the domain you are weakest in
/cert:mock	Runs a full mock exam and marks it
/cert:score-check	Converts a mock score to the scaled score
exam-coach skill	A Claude Code skill that runs the whole cycle

💡 Tip

A question bank and a flashcard deck sit beside them, so the same material can be drilled in the terminal or on cards.

What I Would Tell You

Six things I learned building this, offered for whatever they are worth.

1 Read the blueprint before anything else.

Anthropic publishes exactly what each exam tests and how it is weighted. Everything I wrote is downstream of that document, and so is the exam.

2 Learn the whole syllabus before you pay.

The courses are free on the public Academy. Only the proctored exam needs a partner account, so there is no reason to spend anything until you are ready to sit.

3 Sit the mocks under exam conditions.

Closed book, timed, one sitting. A mock you pause and look things up in measures your reading, not your recall.

4 Work the domains you are worst at.

Scaled scoring means a weak domain costs more than a strong one gains. Practice where it hurts.

5 Do not go looking for exam questions.

The practice questions here are original. Braindumps break the terms you agreed to and teach you the wrong things anyway.

6 Read the cheat sheet in the hour before.

One page per exam, written to be the last thing you look at. That is what it is for.

👩 Tip

The credential lasts twelve months. What you learn getting it lasts longer, and it is free to learn.

Explore Further

Where the rest of the work lives.

Related repositories

CLAUDE-CERTIFICATIONS	The repository this document indexes
Website	The same material as a searchable site
AI-SKILLS	Skills and prompts for AI coding agents
ACHIEVEMENTS	Every certification and course completion

Elsewhere

GitHub	github.com/Amey-Thakur
Amey's Arc	amey-thakur.github.io
ORCID	0000-0001-5644-1575
Google Scholar	Publications and citations
ResearchGate	researchgate.net/profile/Amey-Thakur
arXiv	arxiv.org/a/thakur_a_3
Kaggle	kaggle.com/ameythakur20
Hugging Face	huggingface.co/ameythakur
LinkedIn	linkedin.com/in/amey-thakur
YouTube	Engineering project demonstrations

A Closing Note

The repository is the material. This is the index to it, written so someone arriving without context can find the part they need.

! **Important**

Certification programs change: fees, item counts, domain weights and policies all move. Every figure here was true when this was written. Anthropic's own exam guides are the authority.

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